SOCIOECONOMIC FALSE BELIEF #36 · LIFE-STAGE PRESSURES

“Retirement means I'm no longer useful.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

For many people, work gave structure, status, and purpose. When it ends, whether by choice, health, or company decision, the days can feel empty and the world can seem to stop needing us. A culture that praises youth and productivity makes it worse, and so do family messages about “earning your keep.”

What Scripture teaches

Scripture speaks warmly of the elderly. The psalmist says the righteous will flourish, and in old age they will still bear fruit. Proverbs calls gray hair a crown of glory. The psalmist prays, “Even when I am old and gray, O God, do not forsake me, until I proclaim Your power to the next generation.” God says, “Even to your old age I will be the same, and to your graying years I will carry you.” Usefulness in God’s kingdom does not end with a career.

> *“In old age they will still bear fruit; healthy and green they will remain”* (Psalm 92:14).

Also see

> “Even when I am old and gray, do not forsake me, O God, until I proclaim Your power to the next generation, Your might to all who are to come” (Psalm 71:18).

> “Gray hair is a crown of glory; it is attained along the path of righteousness” (Proverbs 16:31).

> “Even to your old age, I will be the same, and I will bear you up when you turn gray. I have made you, and I will carry you; I will sustain you and deliver you” (Isaiah 46:4).

> “The righteous will flourish like a palm tree, and grow like a cedar in Lebanon” (Psalm 92:12).

Common self-statements

- Nobody needs me anymore.
- I have nothing left to give.
- My best years are behind me.
- I am just waiting around.
- I have no purpose without work.
- The world has moved on.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either working and useful or retired and useless.
- Fortune telling: Predicting a meaningless future.
- Mental filter: Noticing the loss of role and missing the new opportunities.
- Labeling: Calling myself “retired” as if it were a verdict.

Challenging questions

- What do I have to give that a lifetime of experience has made possible?
- Who could use my time, wisdom, or help?
- What did I always want to do but did not have time for?
- What does God say about fruitfulness in old age?

- What did work give me that I need to find elsewhere, such as structure, people, or purpose?
- What is one place I could serve this month?

Truth summary

> My usefulness to God and others does not end with my career. I can still bear fruit, teach, serve, pray, and enjoy. This season may be one of the most meaningful, and I can look for how God wants to use me now.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Elderly
- Self-Esteem, Low
- Servant
- Strength
- Fruitful

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Suffering

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Do It Again — Steven Curtis Chapman
God's repeated gifts and new mercies express His continuing love.

Forever — Kari Jobe
Christ's resurrection grounds hope in His victory over sin and death.

Great Is Thy Faithfulness — CeCe Winans
This classic hymn recalls God's steady mercy through changing circumstances.

How Great Thou Art — Jordan Smith
This classic hymn connects God's greatness, Christ's sacrifice, and future hope.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Retirement means I'm no longer useful"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Retirement means I'm no longer useful." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What can I offer?
- ☐ Who needs my help?
- ☐ What did I always want to do?
- ☐ What does God say about old age?
- ☐ What did work give me that I need to replace?
- ☐ Where could I serve this month?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I can still bear fruit.
- ☐ Gray hair is a crown of glory.
- ☐ God will carry me.
- ☐ My experience is valuable.
- ☐ Purpose does not require a paycheck.
- ☐ This season has its own calling.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Psalm 92:14**
  "In old age they will still bear fruit; healthy and green they will remain."
- ☐ **Psalm 71:18**
  "Even when I am old and gray, do not forsake me, O God, until I proclaim Your power to the next generation, Your might to all who are to come."
- ☐ **Isaiah 46:4**
  "Even to your old age, I will be the same, and I will bear you up when you turn gray. I have made you, and I will carry you; I will sustain you and deliver you."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ How I helped: Each week, write one way you were useful to someone, in a small way or large.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 92:14 becomes: "Sarah can write: "In old age I can still bear fruit, so I am still useful to God.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Elderly" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

This card is educational and is not financial or legal advice. Choose steps you can do safely. If you are without food, housing, or safety, contact your church, a trusted advisor, or local assistance services.

- ☐ List what you can offer. Write skills, stories, and gifts that others could use.
- ☐ Find one place to serve. Contact a church, school, nonprofit, or neighbor and offer your time.
- ☐ Build a routine. Create a simple daily rhythm with prayer, activity, and people.
- ☐ Mentor someone. Offer to share what you know with a younger person.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Retirement means I'm no longer useful": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A way I served
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Retirement means I'm no longer useful.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, You said we will still bear fruit in old age. Show me where You want to use me in this season, and free me from the belief that I am no longer needed. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

SOCIOECONOMIC FALSE BELIEF #37 · LIFE-STAGE PRESSURES

“Caring for others means my needs don't count.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Parents, caregivers for aging relatives, and people in helping professions often learn to put themselves last. Family messages like “Don’t be selfish” or religious teaching that confuses sacrifice with self-erasure can add to it. Over time, we may stop noticing our own needs, grow tired and resentful, and still feel guilty for wanting anything.

What Scripture teaches

Jesus said the second great commandment is to love our neighbor as ourselves, which assumes that we also care for ourselves. Paul says no one ever hated his own body, but nourishes and cherishes it. Paul also says to look not only to our own interests, but also to the interests of others, which means both. When Elijah was exhausted, God let him sleep and sent an angel to say, “Get up and eat.” Caring for ourselves is not selfish. It is how we keep loving others.

> *“And the second is like it: ‘Love your neighbor as yourself.’”* (Matthew 22:39).

Also see

> “Indeed, no one ever hated his own body, but he nourishes and cherishes it, just as Christ does the church” (Ephesians 5:29).

> “Each of you should look not only to your own interests, but also to the interests of others” (Philippians 2:4).

> “Then he lay down under the broom tree and fell asleep. Suddenly an angel touched him and said, ‘Get up and eat.’” (1 Kings 19:5).

> “He makes me lie down in green pastures; He leads me beside quiet waters” (Psalm 23:2).

Common self-statements

- My needs are not important.
- Taking time for myself is selfish.
- Everyone else comes first.
- If I stop, everything will fall apart.
- I should not need anything.
- Good people do not have needs.

Common logical errors

- Should statements: Insisting that I must always put others first.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing that I must either serve others or be selfish.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling guilty and concluding that I am wrong to rest.
- Magnification: Treating a short break as a failure of love.

Challenging questions

- Where did I learn that my needs do not count?
- What would happen to the people I love if I became exhausted or ill?
- What does “love your neighbor as yourself” say about how I treat myself?
- What do I need most right now?

- Who could share some of the load?
- What is one small way I can care for myself this week?

Truth summary

> My needs count to God, and caring for myself helps me keep loving others. I can care for the people in my life without erasing myself and can ask for help without guilt.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Self-Sacrifice
- Tired
- Servant
- Help
- Love, For Others

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Weak/Tired
- Love

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Thrive — Casting Crowns
Life rooted in God includes purposeful growth and joy, not merely surviving or staying busy.

Oh My Soul — Casting Crowns
Honest distress can coexist with faith and hope in God.

Softly and Tenderly — Kristyn Getty with Vince Gill, Ellie Holcomb and Sierra Hull
This older hymn pictures Christ's gracious invitation to return rather than hide in shame.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

My Plan for Replacing "Caring for others means my needs don't count"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Caring for others means my needs don't count." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Where did I learn that my needs do not count?
- ☐ What do I need right now?
- ☐ Who could share the load?
- ☐ What happens if I run out of strength?
- ☐ What is one small act of self-care?
- ☐ How can I ask for help this week?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ My needs matter to God.
- ☐ Love your neighbor as yourself includes me.
- ☐ Rest helps me love well.
- ☐ I can ask for help.
- ☐ Self-care is not selfishness.
- ☐ I can care for others and for myself.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Matthew 22:39
  "And the second is like it: 'Love your neighbor as yourself.'"
- ☐ Ephesians 5:29
  "Indeed, no one ever hated his own body, but he nourishes and cherishes it, just as Christ does the church."
- ☐ 1 Kings 19:5
  "Then he lay down under the broom tree and fell asleep. Suddenly an angel touched him and said, 'Get up and eat.'"

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] One need met: Each day, name one need you had and one small way you met it or asked for help.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Matthew 22:39 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I can love my neighbor as myself, so my needs matter too.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Self-Sacrifice" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

This card is educational and is not financial or legal advice. Choose steps you can do safely. If you are without food, housing, or safety, contact your church, a trusted advisor, or local assistance services.

- [ ] List your needs. Write physical, emotional, and spiritual needs you have been ignoring.
- [ ] Ask for help. Choose one task to hand off to someone else this week.
- [ ] Schedule a recharge. Put a block of rest or enjoyment on the calendar.
- [ ] Pray Matthew 22:39. Ask God to show you how to love yourself as He does.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Caring for others means my needs don't count": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A need I honored
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Caring for others means my needs don't count.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, You care for the one who cares for others. Forgive me for ignoring my needs. Show me how to love my neighbor and myself, and give me the grace to ask for help. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

SOCIOECONOMIC FALSE BELIEF #38 · LIFE-STAGE PRESSURES

“As a parent, I must provide everything.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Parents want the best for their children, and many feel a heavy weight to provide every opportunity. A parent who grew up with little may vow that their children will never lack, and one who grew up with much may fear lowering the standard. Social media and comparisons add pressure. The result can be exhaustion, debt, and children who learn that love equals resources.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture does say that a person who does not provide for his own household has denied the faith, so providing is a real responsibility. But provision is also something God shares. The psalmist says that unless the Lord builds the house, its builders labor in vain. Jesus says that our heavenly Father knows what we need. Proverbs says that the righteous man who walks with integrity leaves blessing to his children. Our children need provision, but they also need our presence, example, and faith, which no budget can supply.

> *“Unless the LORD builds the house, its builders labor in vain; unless the LORD protects the city, its watchmen stand guard in vain”* (Psalm 127:1).

Also see

> “For the Gentiles strive after all these things, and your heavenly Father knows that you need them” (Matthew 6:32).

> “The righteous man walks with integrity; blessed are his children after him” (Proverbs 20:7).

> “These words I am commanding you today are to be upon your hearts. And you shall teach them diligently to your children and speak of them when you sit at home and when you walk along the road, when you lie down and when you get up” (Deuteronomy 6:6–7).

> “If anyone does not provide for his own, and especially his own household, he has denied the faith and is worse than an unbeliever” (1 Timothy 5:8).

Common self-statements

- If my kids lack anything, I have failed.
- I have to give them everything I did not have.
- Good parents provide every opportunity.
- Other parents give their children more.
- I must never say no.
- It all depends on me.

Common logical errors

- Should statements: Insisting that I must provide everything.
- Personalization: Taking sole responsibility for my children’s outcomes.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing that I either give everything or fail.
- Social comparison: Measuring myself against other parents.

Challenging questions

- What do my children most need from me, besides things?
- What did I wish my parents had given me, and was it money?
- Where is the pressure to provide coming from?
- What can I trust God with in my children's lives?
- What would it teach my children if I said no sometimes?
- What is a "good enough" level of provision for our family?

Truth summary

> I am responsible to provide wisely, but I am not the source of everything. God knows what my children need and shares the load with me. My presence, faith, and example are part of their provision.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Parenting
- Children
- Money
- Trust
- Plans

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Parenting
- Money/Riches

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Good Good Father — Chris Tomlin
God's fatherly love is deeper than human approval or achievement.

Our God — Chris Tomlin
God's greatness challenges helplessness before evil or hardship.

Already There — Casting Crowns
God's perspective extends beyond what we can currently understand.

Great Is Thy Faithfulness — CeCe Winans
This classic hymn recalls God's steady mercy through changing circumstances.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "As a parent, I must provide everything"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"As a parent, I must provide everything." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What do my children most need?
- ☐ Where is the pressure coming from?
- ☐ What did I want from my parents?
- ☐ What can I trust God with?
- ☐ What would a kind no look like?
- ☐ How can I give my time this week?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I can provide wisely without providing everything.
- ☐ Unless the Lord builds the house, we labor in vain.
- ☐ My children need my presence.
- ☐ God knows what my children need.
- ☐ Saying no can teach valuable lessons.
- ☐ Good enough is enough.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Psalm 127:1**
  "Unless the LORD builds the house, its builders labor in vain; unless the LORD protects the city, its watchmen stand guard in vain."
- ☐ **Matthew 6:32**
  "For the Gentiles strive after all these things, and your heavenly Father knows that you need them."
- ☐ **Proverbs 20:7**
  "The righteous man walks with integrity; blessed are his children after him."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Provision and presence: Each week, note one way you gave your children time or example, not only things.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 127:1 becomes: "Sarah can write: "Unless the Lord builds the house, we labor in vain, so I can trust God with what I cannot give.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Parenting" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

This card is educational and is not financial or legal advice. Choose steps you can do safely. If you are without food, housing, or safety, contact your church, a trusted advisor, or local assistance services.

- ☐ Write what your children need. List needs versus wants, including emotional and spiritual needs.
- ☐ Say a kind no. Practice declining a request that stretches the budget and explain why.
- ☐ Give time. Plan one activity that costs little and gives your full attention.
- ☐ Pray for your children. Entrust one area to God each day.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "As a parent, I must provide everything": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Time over things
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~As a parent, I must provide everything.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I love my children and want the best for them. Free me from the belief that I must provide everything. Teach me to give wisely, to be present, and to trust You with what I cannot give. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

SOCIOECONOMIC FALSE BELIEF #39 · LIFE-STAGE PRESSURES

“I'm a burden now that I can't work.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Illness, injury, disability, or age can limit work, and with it independence and income. Receiving care, relying on family, or needing help with money can feel like a burden to others. If we were always the strong one, being on the receiving side can be painful. The thought “They would be better off without me” can grow in the dark.

What Scripture teaches

Paul says that the parts of the body that seem to be weaker are indispensable. We who are strong ought to bear with the weak, and we are to bear one another’s burdens. The psalmist prays, “Do not cast me away in my old age; do not forsake me when my strength is gone,” and God answers, “I have made you, and I will carry you.” Receiving care is part of how the body of Christ works. A person who cannot work still holds a place in the family and in God’s heart.

> *“On the contrary, the parts of the body that seem to be weaker are indispensable”* (1 Corinthians 12:22).

Also see

> “Do not discard me in my old age; do not forsake me when my strength fails” (Psalm 71:9).

> “Even to your old age, I will be the same, and I will bear you up when you turn gray. I have made you, and I will carry you; I will sustain you and deliver you” (Isaiah 46:4).

> “We who are strong ought to bear with the shortcomings of the weak and not to please ourselves” (Romans 15:1).

> “Carry one another’s burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ” (Galatians 6:2).

Common self-statements

- My family would be better off without me.
- I am just a drain on everyone.
- I used to contribute and now I cannot.
- I am a weight on those I love.
- I should not need so much.
- I am useless now.

Common logical errors

- Mind reading: Assuming that my family sees me as a burden.
- Labeling: Calling myself “a burden.”
- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing that I am either productive or a burden.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling like a burden and concluding that I am.

Challenging questions

- What have my family members actually said or done?
- What do I give to my family that is not work, such as love, prayer, wisdom, or presence?
- If my spouse or parent were in my place, would I see them as a burden?

- What does Scripture say about those who seem weaker?
- What would it mean to receive care graciously?
- Who could I talk to about how I feel?

Truth summary

> Needing help does not make me a burden. In the body of Christ the weaker parts are indispensable, and in my family I am loved for who I am. I can receive care with grace and keep giving what I can, such as love, prayer, and presence.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Weakness
- Sickness
- Help
- Elderly
- Self-Esteem, Low

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Weak/Tired
- Self-Esteem, Low

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

He Knows — Jeremy Camp
Jesus understands suffering and invites people to bring their burdens to Him.

The God Who Stays — Matthew West
God's faithful presence challenges the expectation of rejection and abandonment.

Because He Lives — Bill and Gloria Gaither
This older favorite grounds courage for tomorrow in Christ's resurrection.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I'm a burden now that I can't work"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I'm a burden now that I can't work." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What have my loved ones actually said?
- ☐ What do I give that is not work?
- ☐ How would I view someone else in my place?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about the weaker parts?
- ☐ How can I receive help gracefully?
- ☐ Who can I talk with?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ The weaker parts are indispensable.
- ☐ I am loved for who I am, not what I do.
- ☐ Receiving care is part of life together.
- ☐ I still have gifts to give.
- ☐ God carries me.
- ☐ I can accept help with grace.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ 1 Corinthians 12:22
  "On the contrary, the parts of the body that seem to be weaker are indispensable."
- ☐ Psalm 71:9
  "Do not discard me in my old age; do not forsake me when my strength fails."
- ☐ Isaiah 46:4
  "Even to your old age, I will be the same, and I will bear you up when you turn gray. I have made you, and I will carry you; I will sustain you and deliver you."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ What I give: Each day, write one non-work thing you gave to someone, such as a prayer, a listening ear, or a word of thanks.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, 1 Corinthians 12:22 becomes: "Sarah can write: "The parts that seem weaker are indispensable, so I am not a burden.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Weakness" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

This card is educational and is not financial or legal advice. Choose steps you can do safely. If you are without food, housing, or safety, contact your church, a trusted advisor, or local assistance services.

- ☐ Ask a loved one. Ask, "What does my being here mean to you?" and listen.
- ☐ List what you still give. Write ten ways you contribute that do not require work.
- ☐ Say thank you well. Practice receiving help with gratitude instead of apology.
- ☐ Talk to someone. If heavy thoughts continue, speak to a pastor, counselor, or doctor, and if you ever feel unsafe, contact a crisis line right away.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie “I'm a burden now that I can't work”: _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A gift I gave
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'm a burden now that I can't work.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, You carry me. Quiet the thought that I am a burden. Help me receive care gracefully, give what I can, and remember that I am loved by You and by those around me. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

SOCIOECONOMIC FALSE BELIEF #40 · LIFE-STAGE PRESSURES

“Needing help means losing my dignity.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Many of us learned that independence is a mark of maturity and that asking for help is a loss of standing. Pride, family pride, or past experiences when help came with humiliation can feed this belief. It can keep people from using resources, seeing doctors, accepting meals, or asking for a loan or a ride when they truly need one.

What Scripture teaches

God made humanity a little lower than the heavenly beings and crowned us with glory and honor. That honor does not depend on how much we need. Jesus said, “It is not those who are well who need a physician, but those who are sick,” and Paul reminds us that it is more blessed to give than to receive, which means someone must receive. Proverbs says that with humility comes wisdom. Asking for help is a way to honor God’s design, in which we are made to need Him and each other.

> *“Jesus answered, ‘It is not the healthy who need a doctor, but the sick.’”* (Luke 5:31).

Also see

> “You made him a little lower than the angels; You crowned him with glory and honor” (Psalm 8:5).

> “In everything, I showed you that by this kind of hard work we must help the weak, remembering the words of the Lord Jesus Himself: ‘It is more blessed to give than to receive.’” (Acts 20:35).

> “When pride comes, disgrace follows, but with humility comes wisdom” (Proverbs 11:2).

> “Carry one another’s burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ” (Galatians 6:2).

Common self-statements

- Real adults do not need help.
- If I ask, I am admitting defeat.
- People will lose respect for me.
- I would rather struggle alone than owe anyone.
- Taking help means I am weak.
- Needing anything is humiliating.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing that I am either independent and dignified or needy and shamed.
- Mind reading: Assuming people will think less of me.
- Should statements: Insisting that I should never need help.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling embarrassed and concluding that asking is wrong.

Challenging questions

- Where did I learn that asking for help is a loss?
- What would I think of a friend who asked me for help?
- When have I helped someone, and how did it feel?
- What does it cost me when I refuse help?

- What does God's crown of glory and honor say about my dignity?
- What is one small request I could make this week?

Truth summary

> My dignity comes from being made in God's image and crowned with glory and honor, not from how little I need. Asking for help is wise and humble, and it gives others the blessing of giving. I can receive help with gratitude and keep my dignity.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Help
- Humility
- Pride
- Weakness
- Friendship

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Pride

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Songs that speak truth to this belief

You Say — Lauren Daigle
God's loving assessment challenges identity based only on weakness or feelings.

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

What a Friend We Have in Jesus — Keith and Kristyn Getty
This classic hymn invites direct, honest prayer with the Savior who carries our burdens.

Amazing Grace — Reawaken Hymns
This classic hymn locates salvation and sustaining hope in grace rather than merit.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

My Plan for Replacing "Needing help means losing my dignity"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Needing help means losing my dignity." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Where did I learn that asking is shameful?
- ☐ What do I need right now?
- ☐ What would I say to a friend who asked me?
- ☐ What does asking cost me?
- ☐ What is one small request?
- ☐ How can I say thank you well?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ My dignity comes from God.
- ☐ Asking for help is wise.
- ☐ Receiving lets others give.
- ☐ We were made to need each other.
- ☐ Humility brings wisdom.
- ☐ I can accept help and still be honored.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Luke 5:31**
  "Jesus answered, 'It is not the healthy who need a doctor, but the sick.'"
- ☐ **Psalm 8:5**
  "You made him a little lower than the angels; You crowned him with glory and honor."
- ☐ **Acts 20:35**
  "In everything, I showed you that by this kind of hard work we must help the weak, remembering the words of the Lord Jesus Himself: 'It is more blessed to give than to receive.'"

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

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PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ A request made: Each week, note one time you asked for or accepted help and how it went.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 8:5 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God crowned me with glory and honor, so I can ask for help without losing my dignity.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
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- ☐ Name your needs. Write what you need right now: practical, financial, emotional, or physical.
- ☐ Make one small request. Ask a friend, church, or professional for one specific thing.
- ☐ Say thank you. Respond to help with gratitude instead of apology.
- ☐ Help someone else. Notice how it feels to be asked, and remember it.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

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_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Needing help means losing my dignity": _____ % My truth: _____ %

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My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Needing help means losing my dignity.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, You crowned me with honor. Free me from the belief that needing help takes it away. Give me humility to ask, gratitude to receive, and trust that You provide through people. Amen.

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